



WHILE SOME GROUPS (LIKE THE KOGI IN SOUTH AMERICA) MISKITU

EMBRACING OTHER WAYS

value cultural purity, the Miskitu people of Central America are almost defined by the exotic mix of peoples they've absorbed. Originating from unions between Indians and Afro-

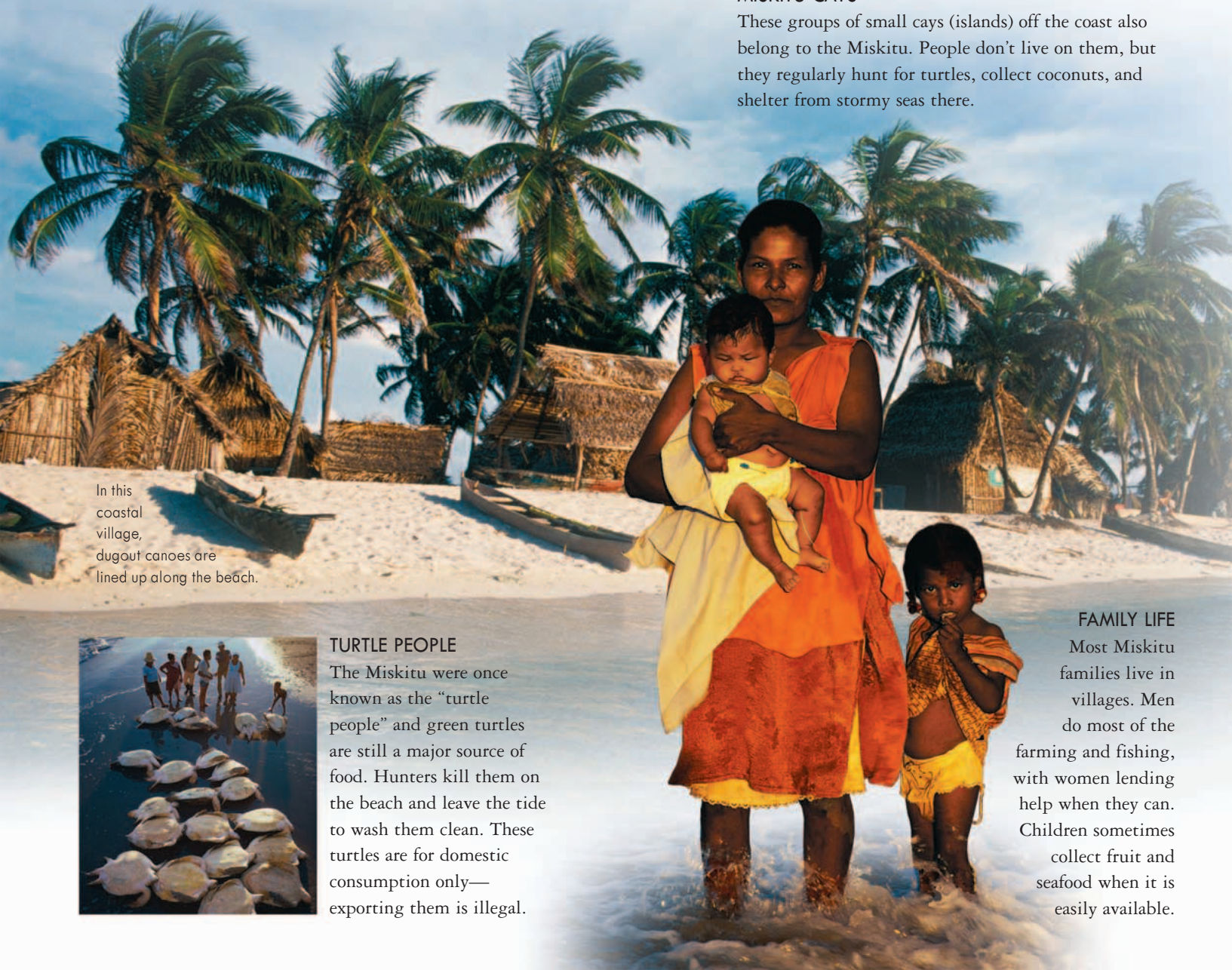
People of the coast

The Miskitu make their home along the Caribbean coast of Nicaragua and Honduras. This territory, known as the Mosquito Coast, is rich in natural resources, yet the people are poor, and many make their living from subsistence farming, fishing, and hunting. They have their own language, also called Miskitu, and many people speak English and Spanish as well.



MISKITU CAYS

These groups of small cays (islands) off the coast also belong to the Miskitu. People don't live on them, but they regularly hunt for turtles, collect coconuts, and shelter from stormy seas there.



In this coastal village, dugout canoes are lined up along the beach.



TURTLE PEOPLE

The Miskitu were once known as the "turtle people" and green turtles are still a major source of food. Hunters kill them on the beach and leave the tide to wash them clean. These turtles are for domestic consumption only—exporting them is illegal.

FAMILY LIFE

Most Miskitu families live in villages. Men do most of the farming and fishing, with women lending help when they can. Children sometimes collect fruit and seafood when it is easily available.